

April

12



1937

Whittle's jet engine

Overcoming doubts raised by scientists, British engineer Frank Whittle successfully tested his invention – the first jet engine designed to power an aircraft. The government helped finance his work during World War II.

Also on this day

1919 Architect **Walter Gropius** founded Bauhaus, an art and design school in Weimar, Germany. It gathered together Europe's most brilliant artists and designers.

1964 Black American civil rights activist **Malcolm X** gave his "Ballot or the Bullet" speech at the King Solomon Baptist Church in Detroit, USA.

1992 Europe's first **Disneyland**, originally called Euro Disneyland Park, opened near Paris.

Born this day

1913 **Keiko Fukuda**, Japanese-American martial artist. She was the highest-ranking female *judoka* in the sport's history.

1925 **Evelyn Berezin**, US computer designer. She developed one of the earliest computer systems for airline reservations.

Human in space

Cosmonaut (Soviet astronaut) Yuri Gagarin spent 108 minutes orbiting Earth in his spacecraft *Vostok 1*, becoming the first person to travel into space. Gagarin's flight was remotely controlled from Earth by a computer program.

1961



1861

Battle of Fort Sumter

The first major battle of the US Civil War took place, following decades of simmering tensions between the Northern and Southern states. Fort Sumter, controlled by the Northern Army, was bombarded by Southern forces.

